

Angry Trump berates Zelensky

Vance vacation is slippery slope as Vermonters weigh politics, tourism

By Kevin Cullen
GLOBE STAFF

WARREN, Vt. — Here in the Mad River Valley, where the Trump administration is about as popular as a rainstorm on the slopes at Sugarbush, news that Vice President JD Vance was coming for a ski weekend was greeted with surprise more than derision.

Not that there isn't plenty of derision. Activists have planned protests in Warren and neighboring Waitsfield. Local social media sites are chockful of bitter recriminations, saying Vance is not welcome here because of the administration's policies against DEI and the mass firings at various federal agencies, among other reasons.

But for many locals, the idea of Vance coming to the state that not only rejected the Trump/Vance ticket by the widest margin, but to an especially liberal part of the state where the administration is wildly unpopular, doesn't add up.

More than 83 percent of voters in this town of roughly 2,000 voted for the Harris/Walz ticket last November. And Vermonters despise Donald Trump so much that Vermont was the only state where Trump challenger Nikki Haley won a primary in 2024, a result that analysts chalk up to many Democrats and Independents voting for Haley to stick it to Trump.

As he finished his morning coffee sitting outside the Warren Store, the general store in the middle of Warren Village, resident Chris Salinder, 72, suggested it may

VANCE, Page A6

WORK REPORTS

Federal workers are expected to receive another email as soon as Saturday asking them to describe what they achieved this past week. **A6.**

SHOPPING LISTS

Massachusetts consumers joined Friday's national 'economic blackout.' But others made a point to spend money instead. **D1.**



TOP AND BOTTOM: SAUL LOEB/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES; MIDDLE: DOUG MILLS/NEW YORK TIMES

As President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine met with President Trump in the Oval Office on Friday, their conversation became more heated, turning into a televised showdown that ended with an angry Trump abruptly ending the visit and grim-faced Zelensky leaving the White House with no agreement on a plan to coordinate peace in his country.

Extraordinary and explosive session plays out on live TV broadcast

By Peter Baker
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The US relationship with Ukraine erupted in a storm of acrimony Friday as President Trump and Vice President JD Vance berated President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine in an explosive televised Oval Office showdown and abruptly cut short a visit meant to coordinate a plan for peace.

In a fiery public confrontation unlike any seen between a US president and foreign leader in modern times, Trump and Vance castigated Zelensky for not being grateful enough for US support in its war with Russia, and sought to strong-arm him into making a peace deal on whatever terms the Americans dictated.

With his voice raised and temper flaring, Trump threatened to abandon Ukraine altogether if Zelensky did not go along. After journalists were escorted out of the Oval Office, Trump canceled the rest of the

ZELENSKY, Page A7

Oval Office dispute sets stage for shift in how global power works

By James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

Friday's Oval Office meeting between President Trump and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky was supposed to be a simple formality for the cameras.

A deal involving the United States helping to develop raw materials in Ukraine was already so far along that it was finally time for Zelensky and Trump to shake hands.

But something different happened.

Over the course of 10 minutes, Trump, Zelensky, and Vice President JD Vance rehashed the past 11 years of Russian aggression in Ukraine and who did what and when. No one seemed happy. After shooing the gaggle of shocked reporters out of the Oval and canceling a planned bilateral press conference, Trump effectively kicked Zelensky out of the White House.

ANALYSIS, Page A7

Rise in measles cases spurs booster questions

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

Measles, one of the world's most contagious viruses, is making a resurgence in the United States, more than two decades after it was declared eliminated in 2000.

An outbreak in west Texas

that spread to New Mexico has sickened at least 146 people, mostly children who were unvaccinated, with roughly 20 hospitalized and one dead — an unvaccinated youngster who was reportedly otherwise healthy. It was the first recorded measles death in the US in a decade.

After initially dismissing the outbreak as not unusual, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the new Health and Human Services secretary, who has a long history of vaccine skepticism, said in a post on X Friday that, "Ending the measles outbreak is a top priority for me and my extraordinary team at

HHS."

The rapidly spreading outbreak comes as vaccination rates among children are declining nationwide amid a rising tide of misinformation and mistrust in such long-respected public health measures.

MEASLES, Page A10

'We're looking at how to address this. Everything's on the table.'

RUBY KAM, Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts

Weight-loss drugs fuel big losses for Mass. insurers

Point32Health, Blue Cross say costs could rise

By Robert Weisman
GLOBE STAFF

Overwhelmed by a surge in demand for popular new weight-loss drugs, the state's two biggest health insurers posted substantial financial losses last year that will likely force them to raise premiums in 2026.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts, the state's top insurer with 3 million members, said Friday it recorded an operating loss of \$400.4 million for 2024, the largest in its history. That was a sharp reversal from the previous year, when it reported op-

erating income of \$47.8 million.

Point32Health, the parent of Harvard Pilgrim Health Plan and Tufts Health Plan, which have 2 million combined members, had an operating loss of \$382 million last year, widening a loss of \$264 million in 2023.

Both insurers cited rapidly growing costs for a broad range of medical care and medications. But the largest driver was the popularity of the expensive GLP-1 drugs used to treat diabetes and obesity.

Costs for five of those drugs — Ozempic, Mounjaro, Wegovy, Zepbound, and Saxenda — topped \$300 million for Blue Cross alone last year, more than double what it

INSURERS, Page A10

Marching orders

Saturday: Cloudy, showers. High: 49-54. Low: 19-24.

Sunday: Sunny, colder. High: 29-34. Low: 10-15.

Sunrise: 6:19 Sunset: 5:34

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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The town of Middleborough sued Governor Maura Healey and the state housing office, seeking an exemption from the controversial MBTA Communities Act. **D1.**



The state Department of Public Utilities cut \$500 million from the three-year budget for the Mass Save energy efficiency program amid complaints about high utility bills. **B3.**

HONORING A COMMUNITY

Smiler Q. Haynes (center) took part in the Age Strong Commission's annual Black Heritage Celebration Friday in Dorchester. Mayor Michelle Wu also joined the event held on the final day of Black History Month.

JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF